



国 外 交 部

特 权 指 令

PRIVILEGED INSTRUCTIONS

Ministry of Foreign Affairs
PEOPLE'S REPUBLIC OF CHINA



Ministry of Foreign Affairs of
the People's Republic of China

Privileged Instructions

Fundamental Principles

- The Arctic situation goes beyond its original inter-Arctic State or regional nature.
- China is a champion for the development of a community in Arctic affairs.
- The survival and development of the Arctic has vital bearing on the international community and the shared future for mankind.

Desired End States

- PRIMARY: Understand, protect, develop, and participate in the governance of the Arctic.
- ALTERNATE: Establish our role as an important stakeholder in Arctic affairs.
- Additional details tied to end states above:
 - Improve the capacity and capability in scientific research in the Arctic.
 - Actively respond to climate change in the Arctic.
 - Improve the capability and capacity of applied Arctic technology to develop shipping routes in the Arctic.
 - Participate in regulating and managing of affairs and activities relating to the Arctic.

Primary Guidance Background

- China prioritizes scientific research, the importance of environmental protection, rational utilization, law-based governance, and international cooperation. We are committed to maintaining peace in a secure and stable Arctic order.
- China promotes practical cooperation in all fields through bilateral and multilateral levels. We propose forming cooperative partnerships between Arctic and non-Arctic states.

Delegation Instructions

Ensure periodic reports, requests for further guidance, or clarifications to the instructions herein are submitted via message to the office of the Foreign Minister.

GENERAL: Below are our negotiation positions during this conference. Deviation from these instructions is to be conferred with the Foreign Minister prior to negotiating.

Though you are trained in Zhànláng Wàijiāo (Wolf Warrior Diplomacy) you must balance this style with that of a more measured approach. Because we are a near-Arctic state we must be included in discussions and decisions. Our economic investment in Finland, Iceland, and Norway should help convince others to include us at the table. Expect that the United States will not engage in bilateral negotiations with us.

Utilize President Xi's dàguó-wàijiāo (Major Country Diplomacy) by taking a more active role in these discussions. Per President Xi's thoughts on diplomacy (in references): "adhere to the correct role

view, emphasize the analysis of the international situation and put yourself in it, and make it clear that China has become the main driving force behind the evolution of the world pattern, and the times and trends are on our side.” And remember that we are “still in a period of important strategic opportunities, and opportunities are more strategic and malleable, the challenge is more complex and global.”

We prefer to work bilaterally with nations. Through this, we are able to better concentrate our discussion(s) and find agreement. Minimize multi-lateral discussions as this diminishes our strength and may sway discussion away from our concerns. This does not mean that you cannot attend multi-lateral discussions, but it is preferred that you try your best to work on bilateral solutions.

As I stated in March, “the so-called ‘wolf warrior diplomacy’ is a discourse trap. Those who create the discourse trap either do not understand China, or Chinese diplomacy, or ignore the facts and have ulterior motives.” Never forget that our diplomacy “has enough kindness and goodwill, but when wolves stand in the way and evil wolves come, Chinese diplomats must ‘dance with wolves’ to defend their home and country.”

Territory

China respects the Arctic states’ exclusive jurisdiction over activities within their national areas. Though we don’t have territorial sovereignty in the Arctic we do have rights with respect to scientific research, navigation, overflight, fishing, laying of submarine cables and pipelines in the high seas and relevant sea areas.

The Polar Silk Road, as part of the Belt and Road Initiative, will bring afford economic development of the Arctic. Joint development of this region will facilitate connectivity and sustainable economic development for Arctic and non-Arctic nations alike.

The region of the Arctic Ocean, outside of EEZs, is still in dispute with the CLCS continental shelf claims. Until these claims are settled this portion of the Arctic is considered high seas and as such open for international exploration and exploitation. Nothing in international law prevents nations from utilizing this portion of the Arctic. The only obstacle is the icepack.

The high seas portion of the Arctic is legally open for exploration and exploitation. We support the EU’s claim that the Arctic should be considered ‘global commons’ and available to any nation to exploit.

Militarization

As a near-Arctic state we are concerned for any conflict affecting the Arctic region. Our mission is to jointly promote peace and security in the Arctic. Our development of icebreakers are not to support military action but to promote the economic development and flow of trade through the Arctic.

As Russia reopens former Soviet-era Arctic bases, the difficulty in accessing some of these areas, and their state of disrepair, has slowed their desired progress. Other Arctic states are nervous that these re-openings are a sign that Russia is beginning a Polar arms race.

Our continued military ties with Russia are mutually beneficial in gaining interoperability. As the trading routes of the BRI develop, Polar Silk Road included, we’ll need to be able to provide security to ensure the free flow of goods. As the primary economy in Asia we are committed to ensure the safety and security of our interests.

Work with Russia to secure basing agreements in the Arctic to allow for us to provide for search and rescue, route security patrols, and monitoring of the Polar Silk Road. Use investment, in construction, of their current military infrastructure in the Arctic as a way to begin the basing agreement process.

We will continue to enhance our Arctic military training with countries like Canada. Any opportunity to gain further knowledge of how to operate in this environment will only pay dividends.

Red Line:

Russian restrictions on the Freedom of Navigation and the right of innocent passage for Chinese vessels along the NSR.

Resources

The Arctic high seas, outside of Arctic coastal state's EEZs is legally available for exploration and exploitation. The continental shelf claims by various Arctic states have not been resolved by the CLCS and are likely to be unresolved. Our growing icebreaker fleet, combined with our technological advances in finding oil and gas reserves, position us well to establish extraction facilities.

Work with Denmark and Finland, as EU member states, to push for the Arctic Ocean to be considered 'global commons'. The high seas portion of the Arctic should be deemed as such and not controlled by the Arctic Five.

Mineral resource extraction in Greenland has been blocked by the Greenland Government. Chinese companies were well positioned to extract these riches before the restriction. Uranium and precious metals are abundant in Greenland. Pressure the Danish Government to influence Greenland to allow for removing the restrictions they recently placed on mining.

Red Line:

- Any blockage of exploration and exploitation rights within the Arctic high seas.
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Environment

The natural conditions of the Arctic, and their changes, have a direct impact on China's climate system and ecological environment. In turn, this impacts our economic interests in agriculture, forestry, fishery, marine industry, and other sectors. We support efforts for a legally binding international agreement on fisheries management in the high seas portion of the Arctic Ocean. China also supports the establishment of an Arctic fisheries management organization.

The Central Committee has announced that we will strengthen our 2030 climate target and reach peak emissions before 2030. The new target date for carbon-neutrality is 2060. Expect the U.S. to criticize the Paris Climate Agreement's stance on our status as a developing nation. Even with this status we are currently below Canada, Russia, and the U.S. in per capita CO₂ emissions.

Governance

Though UNCLOS is used for determination of rightful EEZs and continental shelves we do not feel that it adequately covers all Arctic affairs. The Spitsbergen Treaty, along with other treaties, create areas of conflict with UNCLOS.

Until a common governance structure is agreed upon, we must push for full inclusion in the Arctic Council. We are no longer just a mere observer and require a more active role in Council affairs. Do not allow the U.S. to deny our elevation to a member state. If Arctic Council member states are adamant about denying our status change, try to seek enhanced responsibilities and roles. In time we will prove that we deserve full member state status. Play the long-game and work at eroding other nations' hesitance to include us. Be creative in achieving this goal.

Our activities in the Arctic have gone beyond scientific research and have expanded into diverse areas. With the great powers of the globe engaged in this region we must come to a common governance structure to ensure its development is not hindered by old policies and relationships.

Note both Denmark and Iceland hold member state seats on the Arctic Council. Greenland and the Faroe Islands operate with self-rule governments and autonomy. The northern point, of Denmark proper, is only 460 kilometers more north than our northern border and still well below the Arctic Circle. Iceland's main island lies below the Arctic Circle. Only Grimsey Island, with 100 inhabitants and just over 5 square-kilometers in area, is their only Arctic landmass.

Population

We recognize the sovereignty of the Arctic nations and their dealings with their Indigenous peoples. We do find that our current position, as an observer, on the Arctic Council, places us in a lower tier than Indigenous peoples' organizations in discussions and working groups.